

Minneapolis Small and Underutilized Business (SUBE) Program

Overview

The City of Minneapolis has a Small and Underutilized Business Enterprise (SUBE) program designed to promote participation by minority- and women-owned businesses in city contracting. This program provides opportunities for certified businesses to participate in city contracts either as prime contractors or subcontractors.

Program Benefits

- Access to city contracting opportunities specifically set aside for certified SUBE businesses
- Potential preference points in competitive bidding processes
- Networking opportunities with prime contractors seeking SUBE partners
- Mentorship and technical assistance programs
- Direct access to city buyers and decision makers

Eligibility Requirements

While specific requirements may vary, typical eligibility criteria for SUBE certification include:

Business Ownership Requirements

- At least 51% owned by one or more socially and economically disadvantaged individuals OR women
- Ownership by individuals who are U.S. citizens
- Control of daily business operations by certified owners
- Personal net worth limitations (often below \$1.32M excluding business and primary residence)

Business Requirements

- Independently owned and operated
- Physically located in qualifying counties (Anoka, Carver, Chisago, Dakota, Hennepin, Isanti, Le Sueur, Mille Lacs, Ramsey, Scott, Sherburne, Sibley, Washington, and Wright counties in Minnesota; Pierce and St. Croix counties in Wisconsin)
- Established for-profit business
- Demonstrates potential for business success

Certification Process

1. **Application Submission:** Complete the SUBE application with required documentation
2. **Documentation:** Provide personal financial statements, business financials, tax returns, and ownership documents
3. **Site Visit:** Potential on-site inspection of business operations
4. **Review Process:** Application review by certification committee
5. **Approval:** Notification of certification status
6. **Directory Listing:** Inclusion in city's SUBE directory

Required Documentation

- Completed application form
- Personal financial statements for all owners
- Business financial statements
- Federal tax returns (business and owners)
- Bank statements
- Lease agreements or proof of business location
- Insurance certificates
- Licenses and certifications
- Organizational documents (articles of incorporation, operating agreements)
- Affidavits of ownership and control

Opportunities for JAM Construction

As an estimating services company, JAM Construction could participate in the SUBE program in several ways:

Direct City Contracts

- City departments needing estimating services for their own projects
- Professional services contracts for city-sponsored development projects
- Consulting contracts for project feasibility studies

Subcontracting Opportunities

- Prime contractors seeking SUBE partners to meet city contract goals
- Joint ventures with other contractors on city projects
- Specialty services contracts as a SUBE-certified subcontractor

Contract Goals

- City contracts often include SUBE participation goals (typically 15-25%)
- Prime contractors must make good faith efforts to meet these goals
- Creates demand for certified SUBE partners

Application Strategy

1. **Determine Eligibility:** Confirm ownership meets certification requirements
2. **Gather Documentation:** Collect all required financial and business documents
3. **Submit Application:** Apply through the city's process
4. **Marketing Plan:** Develop strategy to reach prime contractors seeking SUBE partners
5. **Network Building:** Attend city-sponsored SUBE networking events
6. **Follow-up:** Maintain relationships with prime contractors and city buyers

Timeline

- Application submission to certification: 30-60 days
- Annual recertification required
- Directory updates typically quarterly

Additional Resources

- City of Minneapolis Contract Compliance Division
- Minnesota Unified Certification Program (MNUCP) for state-level certification
- SBA 8(a) Business Development Program for federal opportunities
- MWOB (Minority and Women-Owned Business) certifications at state and federal levels

This certification program represents a significant opportunity for JAM Construction to access contracts that may have less competition and specific goals for SUBE participation.